CSIS JAPAN CHAIR

Japan Daily Brief

Saturday, November 14, 2026

1,780 words · 7 min read

RE: Host-nation support tripling demand · Defense ¥60T plan · APEC Takaichi-Xi impasse · Quad summit · Okinawa arrest

NIKKEI 225	USD/JPY	BRENT	BOJ RATE
61,142.35	159.69	$95.84	1.25%
▲ +4.03%	▲ +0.88%	▲ +3.53%	

TOP STORIES

ALLIANCE

White House demanding Japan triple host-nation support for U.S. troops

The United States is demanding Japan provide *¥3 trillion* over the five years starting in fiscal 2027 under the Host Nation Support program — roughly three times the current five-year total of approximately ¥1 trillion, according to government sources. The demand arrives as Tokyo simultaneously debates capping its own five-year defense plan at ¥60 trillion against a Defense Ministry estimate of ¥70-80 trillion, compressing the fiscal space on both sides of the equation.

THE JAPAN TIMES

DEFENSE

Japan considers setting five-year defense spending plan at ¥60 trillion

The government is weighing a *¥60 trillion* ceiling for Japan's next five-year defense spending plan, below the Defense Ministry's own estimate of ¥70 trillion to ¥80 trillion as necessary. The gap between ministry request and government ceiling, if maintained, would represent the largest stated shortfall in Japan's post-2022 defense buildup.

THE JAPAN TIMES

INDO-PACIFIC

PM Takaichi to visit Philippines and China for four days beginning Monday for APEC and bilateral meetings

Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** is set to visit the Philippines and then China beginning Monday, her first visit to China as prime minister, to attend the APEC summit; a formal bilateral with President Xi Jinping remains unconfirmed with Beijing still withholding agreement. Jiji Press separately reports that a Quad leaders summit is likely in the Philippines on Tuesday.

KYODO NEWS / JIJI PRESS · NOV 14, 2026

ALLIANCE

U.S. Air Force captain arrested in Okinawa for alleged drunk driving

Japanese police arrested a 27-year-old US Air Force captain on suspicion of drunk driving in Okinawa on Saturday. The arrest follows by one week a bilateral agreement between Tokyo and Washington on measures aimed at preventing crimes by US service members.

THE JAPAN TIMES

ALLIANCE

US wants Japan to nearly triple budget for hosting American troops

Nikkei Asia independently confirmed the US demand for Japan to nearly triple its host-nation support budget, corroborating Japan Times sourcing on the ¥3 trillion five-year figure. The current Special Measures Agreement runs through March 31, 2027, making the next negotiating round the immediate vehicle for any new figure.

NIKKEI ASIA

DEFENSE

Japan, feeling pressure from potential foes, considers nuclear-powered submarines - Stars and Stripes

Japan is considering acquisition of nuclear-powered submarines in response to pressure from potential adversaries, with Stars and Stripes framing North Korea's accelerating weapons-test pace as a key driver of the debate. The deliberation occurs alongside the defense spending cap discussion and would require revisiting constitutional and alliance-framework constraints.

STRIPES.COM

STAT OF THE DAY

¥3T

US demand for Japan host-nation support over five years from FY2027

The figure is approximately three times the current five-year total of around ¥1 trillion, according to sources cited by Japan Times and Nikkei Asia.

White House demanding Japan triple host-nation support for U.S. troops — Japan Times

JAPANESE GOVERNMENT

KANTEI/PM · CABINET · MOFA · MOD · METI · MOF · BOJ · DIET · SATURDAY, NOVEMBER 14, 2026

PM Watch: No confirmed PM appearance today · 1 day(s) since last confirmed appearance

官邸 · PRIME MINISTER'S OFFICE / KANTEI · *Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi*

Received AZEC 2.0 proposals from Keidanren and LDP parliamentary association

The Kantei published records of PM Takaichi receiving two separate AZEC 2.0 concept proposals — one from Keidanren and one from the LDP's Parliamentary Association of AZEC — as Japan's industry minister

separately attended an AZEC summit focused on Asia's energy resilience.

→ Kantei ↗

外務省 · MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS · *Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi*

Japan-Mexico Foreign Ministers' Meeting and Working Dinner

Foreign Minister Motegi held a bilateral meeting and working dinner with his Mexican counterpart, per a MOFA readout published today.

→ MOFA ↗

外務省 · MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS

Japan's Onoe re-elected as ITU Telecommunication Standardization Bureau Director

MOFA announced the re-election of Mr. Onoe as Director of the Telecommunication Standardization Bureau of the International Telecommunication Union (ITU), a multilateral body governing global telecom standards.

→ MOFA ↗

内閣官房長官 · CHIEF CABINET SECRETARY · *Chief Cabinet Secretary Minoru Kihara*

Government response to Microsoft outage affecting Japanese government systems

Chief Cabinet Secretary Kihara addressed the Microsoft outage that disrupted email and AI services used by the Japanese government; Microsoft subsequently confirmed full restoration of services.

→ nippon.com ↗

内閣官房長官 · CHIEF CABINET SECRETARY · *Chief Cabinet Secretary Minoru Kihara*

Japan to host Chilean and Peruvian presidents next week for bilateral summits

The government announced PM Takaichi is set to hold summit meetings next week with the presidents of Chile and Peru, back-to-back visits that fall ahead of PM Takaichi's departure for the Philippines and China for APEC.

→ Mainichi ↗

DIET SESSIONS / LDP

HOUSE OF COUNCILLORS / OPPOSITION

Opposition presses to expand food tax cut relief period in upper chamber

Opposition parties in the House of Councillors are seeking to expand the scope and duration of consumer relief tied to the food consumption tax cut bill, pressing the government to widen coverage beyond the current proposal.

LDP / GOVERNMENT

LDP Parliamentary Association of AZEC submits formal proposal to PM Takaichi

The LDP's Parliamentary Association for AZEC submitted a formal proposal to PM Takaichi at the Kantei on the AZEC 2.0 concept, coinciding with a parallel Keidanren submission, as Japan positions its energy diplomacy ahead of the AZEC summit.

PUBLIC SENTIMENT & APPROVAL POLLING

POLLSTER	APPROVE	DISAPPROVE

NHK · Nov 11, 2026	**53%**	**32.1%**
JNN · Nov 2, 2026	**64.9%**	**32.5%**
ANN · Oct 19, 2026 **· 26d ago**	**47.1%**	**33.3%**
Asahi · Oct 19, 2026 **· 26d ago**	**50%**	**35%**
Kyodo · Oct 19, 2026 **· 26d ago**	**49.1%**	**33%**
FNN · Oct 19, 2026 **· 26d ago**	**62.6%**	**32.3%**
Yomiuri · Oct 19, 2026 **· 26d ago**	**57%**	**30%**

Discourse: Kyodo's record-low 49.1% approval for the Takaichi Cabinet contrasts with Nikkei's 62% and Yomiuri's 57%, reflecting divergent house effects; Mainichi's one-year editorial on PM Takaichi's 'go-it-alone style widening divisions' marks the first anniversary of her tenure.

Poll tracker: **Observing Japan approval-rating aggregator →**

BUSINESS & ECONOMY

FINANCE · NIKKEI ASIA

US Treasury purchased nearly $500 million in yen during joint July forex intervention

The US Treasury bought *nearly $500 million* in yen during a joint intervention with Japan in July, Nikkei Asia reports, disclosing for the first time the US-side scale of the coordinated operation. The USD/JPY rate has since returned to the 159-160 range as of November 13-14.

MACRO · NIKKEI ASIA

Corporate Japan on track for 20% profit gain driven by growth beyond AI sector

Corporate Japan is on track for a *20 percent* profit gain, with Nikkei Asia reporting the driver is broad-based growth beyond the AI sector. An analyst cited by NHK separately projects four straight quarters of GDP growth.

FINANCE · NIKKEI ASIA · WHI, BAIN CAPITAL, GIC

Bain- and GIC-backed WHI on track for Japan's largest IPO in 2026

WHI, backed by Bain Capital and GIC, is on track to execute Japan's largest IPO of 2026, per Nikkei Asia. The listing is a marker of continued private equity activity in Japan's equity markets following corporate governance reforms.

ENERGY · NIKKEI ASIA

Japan oil companies sustain profit growth despite Strait of Hormuz closure

Japanese oil companies are maintaining profit growth despite the Strait of Hormuz closure, Nikkei Asia reports, as Brent crude trades at $95.84 — up 3.53% on November 13. The resilience reflects inventory management and diversified supply routes.

FINANCE · NIKKEI ASIA · JAPAN TOBACCO INTERNATIONAL

Russia's seizure of Japan Tobacco assets clouds Tokyo's broader investment plans in Russia

Nikkei Asia reports the full seizure of Japan Tobacco International assets under a Putin presidential order is now clouding Tokyo's investment posture toward Russia more broadly, with Japan seeking a path to asset recovery. Foreign Minister Motegi has publicly labeled the seizure 'unusual' and demanded reversal.

REGIONAL PRESSURE WATCH

Normal — 9 items

CHINA

Beijing has not confirmed a formal Takaichi-Xi bilateral at APEC, with the Asahi Shimbun reporting the meeting remains unlikely as China continues to cite PM Takaichi's Taiwan remarks as the core obstacle. Multiple outlets confirm Takaichi departs Monday for her first China visit as prime minister with the summit question unresolved.

NORTH KOREA

Stars and Stripes reports Japan is actively considering nuclear-powered submarines in response to pressure from potential adversaries, with North Korea's accelerating weapons-test pace cited as a primary driver of that internal debate; no new DPRK launch or EEZ splashdown activity toward Japan is reported in today's data.

RUSSIA

Nippon.com reports Russia is 'ramping up pressure' on Japan one month after the FSB detention of Hokkaido Shimbun journalist Yuki Imai in Sakhalin; Nikkei Asia separately reports the full JTI asset seizure under a Putin presidential order is clouding Tokyo's broader investment posture toward Russia, with Foreign Minister Motegi having publicly labeled the seizure 'unusual' and demanded reversal.

Senkaku / ECS: No new China Coast Guard intrusion or scramble data is reported in today's Tier 1 or Tier 4 articles; the persistent baseline of near-daily CCG contiguous-zone presence carries forward.

Bottom line: The dominant regional-pressure variable today is diplomatic rather than kinetic: whether Beijing grants PM Takaichi a bilateral with President Xi at APEC — now days away — will serve as the clearest near-term indicator of whether Japan-China relations can stabilize despite the Taiwan-remarks impasse.

U.S.-JAPAN RELATIONS

ALLIANCE · INDOPACOM

Japan and US participate in annual Joint Senior Leader Seminar

Japan and the United States participated in the annual Joint Senior Leader Seminar under US Pacific Command, reinforcing operational-level military-to-military coordination. The seminar is a standing fixture of the alliance's professional military education framework.

INDO-PACIFIC PARTNERS

SOUTHEAST ASIA · THE JAPAN TIMES

Japan-Philippines oil reserve cooperation deal to be signed during Takaichi's Manila visit

Japan is set to sign a partnership with the Philippines under which Tokyo will help Manila develop a national oil reserve system, enhancing Philippine energy security as part of PM Takaichi's upcoming visit.

INDIA · PACIFIC FORUM

Pacific Forum: changing Indo-Pacific demands stronger India-Japan partnership

A Pacific Forum commentary argues that shifts in the Indo-Pacific security environment demand a strengthened India-Japan partnership as a structural pillar of regional stability.

AUSTRALIA · FT

Italy blocks Germany from joining UK-Japan-Italy GCAP fighter jet programme as equal partner

> Rome rejected a push to invite Berlin to enter the Global Combat Air Programme (GCAP) — the UK-Japan-Italy next-generation fighter project — as an equal partner, delivering a setback to Germany's bid to join the trilateral defence industrial effort.

UPCOMING

Nov 17

Quad Leaders Summit — Philippines (expected Tuesday)

Japan and other Quad leaders are likely to convene in the Philippines on Tuesday, per Jiji Press, coinciding with PM Takaichi's Manila stop ahead of APEC.

Nov 17

PM Takaichi to host Chilean and Peruvian presidents — Tokyo

Back-to-back bilateral summits with the presidents of Chile and Peru are scheduled next week at the Kantei, per the Japanese government.

Nov 18

PM Takaichi departs for Philippines and China — first China visit as PM

The four-day trip beginning Monday includes APEC in China; whether a Takaichi-Xi bilateral will occur remains unconfirmed as of today.

Nov 19

First-ever US-China-Russia trilateral summit — Shenzhen

The White House confirmed a US-China-Russia leaders summit on November 19 in Shenzhen to discuss nuclear arms reduction and Iran; Japanese and allied officials are tracking the meeting's implications for the Indo-Pacific order.

Mar 31

Current US-Japan Host-Nation Support Special Measures Agreement expires

The existing agreement — running at approximately ¥211 billion per year — expires March 31, 2027; the US demand for a tripled ¥3 trillion five-year successor sets the terms for negotiations now underway.

CSIS Japan Chair

JAPAN DAILY BRIEF

Washington, D.C.

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↑ BACK TO TOP

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